MyAccounting — Implementation Guide

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Target audience: IT administrators, project leads, and technical staff responsible for deploying MyAccounting at a client site.

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1. Overview

MyAccounting is a Windows desktop accounting application for small Canadian service businesses. It covers the complete accounts-receivable cycle — invoicing, cash receipts, general ledger, and financial reporting — backed by a local Microsoft SQL Server database.

Key characteristics:

Attribute	Value
Platform	Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit)
Language	Python 3.x (Tkinter GUI)
Database	Microsoft SQL Server (local, Windows Auth)
Reporting	PDF and Excel via ReportLab and openpyxl
Languages	English and French
Packaging	PyInstaller standalone `.exe`

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2. System Requirements

Minimum hardware

Component	Requirement
CPU	64-bit, 2 GHz or faster
RAM	4 GB (8 GB recommended)
Disk	2 GB free space
Display	1280 × 768 or higher
Network	Not required for normal use; internet for email and initial install only

Software prerequisites

Prerequisite	Version	Notes
Windows	10 or 11 (64-bit)	Server 2019/2022 also supported
SQL Server	2017, 2019, or 2022	Express edition is free and sufficient
ODBC Driver	17 for SQL Server	Must be installed on the workstation
Python	3.9 or later	Only required for developer/manual install

> **Installer path:** The `MyAccountingSetup.exe` installer handles SQL Server Express and ODBC Driver 17 automatically — no manual prerequisite setup is needed for end-user deployments.

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3. Pre-Implementation Checklist

Complete the following before beginning the installation:

- [ ] Confirm Windows version is 10 or 11 (64-bit)
- [ ] Confirm the user account running the installer has local Administrator rights
- [ ] Have internet access available (only needed if SQL Server / ODBC Driver must be downloaded)
- [ ] Decide on the installation directory (default: `C:\Program Files\MyAccounting`)
- [ ] Gather company information: name, address, phone, email, website
- [ ] Gather the opening GL balances from your previous system (if migrating)
- [ ] Decide on the initial admin username and password
- [ ] Have the Chart of Accounts from the previous system available (CSV or Sage 50 export)
- [ ] Identify which users will access the application and what their roles will be
- [ ] Confirm SMTP credentials for outbound email (server, port, username, password)

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4. Installation

4.1 End-User Install (Installer Wizard)

This is the recommended path for all client deployments.

1. Copy `MyAccountingSetup.exe` to the target computer.
2. Right-click the file and select **Run as administrator**.
3. Accept the UAC prompt.
4. Follow the wizard pages:

Page	Action
Welcome	Review the summary and click **Next**
System Check	Wait for SQL Server and ODBC Driver checks to complete (✅ all three required)
Install Directory	Accept the default or browse to an alternate folder; click **Next**
Industry	Select the industry that best matches the business; review the account preview; click **Next**
Company Info	Enter company name, address, phone, email; click **Next**
Admin Account	Enter the initial admin username and password; click **Next**
Review	Confirm all settings and click **Install**
Finish	Click **Launch MyAccounting** or **Close**

> A desktop shortcut (`MyAccounting`) and Start Menu entry are created automatically.

What the installer does automatically

- Detects or installs SQL Server 2022 Express
- Detects or installs ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server
- Creates the `myaccounting` database
- Creates all application tables
- Loads the industry-specific Chart of Accounts
- Creates the admin user
- Saves company settings

4.2 Developer / Manual Install

Use this path to run from source during development or testing.

```
# 1. Clone or extract the project
cd C:\local\python\MyAccounting

# 2. Install Python dependencies
pip install pyodbc reportlab openpyxl tkcalendar

# 3. Create the SQL Server database
#    (on localhost, Windows Auth, database name: myaccounting)

# 4. Import seed data and create all tables
python import_data.py

# 5. Launch the application
python app.py
```

> For Anaconda environments, use `conda activate <env>` before pip installs.

Build a standalone executable

```
# From the project root
build.bat
```

This runs PyInstaller with `MyAccounting.spec` and produces `dist\MyAccounting\MyAccounting.exe`.

Build the installer

```
cd DeploymentPackage
build_installer.bat
```

Output: `DeploymentPackage\dist\MyAccountingSetup.exe`

> The `MyAccounting.spec` file references Anaconda at `C:\Users\danie\anaconda3`. Update the `_anaconda` path if the build machine uses a different location.

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5. Database Setup

5.1 Create the Database

```
-- Run in SQL Server Management Studio or sqlcmd
CREATE DATABASE myaccounting;
```

The application connects using Windows Trusted Authentication:

```
Driver={ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server};
Server=localhost;
Database=myaccounting;
Trusted_Connection=yes;
```

No SQL Server username or password is required. The Windows user running the application must have `db_owner` access on the `myaccounting` database.

5.2 Run the Schema Migration

Schema creation and all migrations run automatically on first launch via `db.ensure_app_tables()`. No manual SQL scripts are needed.

On each application start, `db.py`:

1. Creates any missing tables
2. Adds any new columns via `ALTER TABLE` (safe to re-run; uses `IF NOT EXISTS` guards)
3. Syncs the boolean status flags from the `status` text column
4. Runs any named data migrations (e.g., account column type changes)

5.3 Import Seed Data

Place all files in the `importdir\` folder, then run:

```
python import_data.py
```

The script reads each file, creates the required tables if they do not exist, and inserts the records. All files use **comma-separated values (CSV)**, quoted with double-quotes, encoded in **Windows-1252** (cp1252). No header row unless stated otherwise.

> Run `import_data.py` **once only**. It truncates and re-inserts each table on every run — any data entered in the application will be lost if the script is re-run.

`customers.txt`

One customer per line. No header row. Minimum 14 columns; column 15 (customer type) is optional.

Col #	Field	Type	Example
0	Company name	Text	`"TPG Technology Consulting Ltd."`
1	Contact name	Text	`"Keith Wilson"`
2	Address line 1	Text	`"887 Richmond Road"`
3	Address line 2	Text	`""` (leave blank if none)
4	City	Text	`"Ottawa"`
5	Province / State	Text	`"Ontario"`
6	Country	Text	`"Canada"`
7	Postal / ZIP code	Text	`"K2AG8"`
8	Phone	Text	`"(613) 798-7647"`
9	Cell	Text	`""`
10	Fax	Text	`"(613) 882-7497"`
11	Email	Text	`"keith.wilson@tpg.ca"`
12	Website	Text	`"tpg.ca"`
13	Currency code	Text	`"CAD"`
14	Customer type	Text	`"Regular"` or `"Preferred"`

Example row:

```
"TPG Technology Consulting Ltd.","Keith Wilson","887 Richmond Road","","Ottawa","Ontario","Canada","K2AG8","(613) 798-7647","(613) 882-7
```

`inventory.txt`

One service item per line. No header row. Minimum 8 columns; columns 6 and 8+ are unused by the importer (pass zeros or leave blank).

Col #	Field	Type	Example
0	Item code	Text	`"SubContract-TPG"`
1	Description	Text	`"Sub contracting with TPG Consulting Group"`
2	Item type	Text	`"Service"`
3	Unit	Text	`"Hour"`, `"Day"`, `"Month"`, `"Each"`
4	Selling price	Decimal	`760`
5	Cost	Decimal	`760`
6	*(unused)*	—	`0`
7	Revenue GL account	Text	`"4325"`
8+	*(ignored)*	—	`0`

Example row:

```
"SubContract-TPG","Sub contracting with TPG Consulting Group","Service","Day",760,760,0,4325,0,0,
```

`projects.txt`

One project per line. No header row. Two columns.

Col #	Field	Type	Example
0	Project code	Text	`"PWG8007607"`
1	Start date	Date (m/d/yyyy)	`"9/9/2024"`

Example rows:

```
"PWG8007607",9/9/2024,
"TBIPS152-27 (TA 7008528814)",6/23/2025,
```

`gldetails.csv`

Contains both the **Chart of Accounts** (account master) and all **transaction history** in a single flat file. This is the format produced by a Sage 50 / Simply Accounting G/L detail export.

Required header row (first line):

```
account_number,account_name,date,description,source_number,trans_no,debits,credits,balance_type
```

Column	Type	Description
`account_number`	Text	GL account number (e.g., `1060`, `4335`)
`account_name`	Text	Account description (e.g., `"Chequing Bank Account (TD)"`)
`date`	Date (yyyy-mm-dd)	Transaction date
`description`	Text	Narrative / journal description
`source_number`	Text	Source document or reference number
`trans_no`	Text	Journal entry number (e.g., `J1`, `J15`)
`debits`	Decimal	Debit amount (use `0` if credit)
`credits`	Decimal	Credit amount (use `0` if debit)
`balance_type`	Text	Normal balance: `Dr` (assets, expenses) or `Cr` (liabilities, equity, revenue)

The importer builds `glmaster` (one row per unique `account_number`) and `gldetails` (one row per transaction line) from this file. Accounts with no transactions are omitted from `glmaster` unless they appear in `openingbalances.csv`.

Example rows:

```
account_number,account_name,date,description,source_number,trans_no,debits,credits,balance_type
1060,Chequing Bank Account (TD),2025-08-27,TPG Technology Consulting Ltd.,20241013,J1,18893.60,0,Dr
1060,Chequing Bank Account (TD),2025-09-25,TPG Technology Consulting Ltd.,20241014,J15,17176.00,0,Dr
4325,Sub-Contract Revenue,2025-08-27,TPG Technology Consulting Ltd.,20241013,J1,0,17176.00,Cr
```

> **Sage 50 export tip:** In Sage 50 go to **Reports** → **Financials** → **General Ledger**, set the date range to cover all history, and export to CSV. The importer detects whether the file is already in the flat format above or needs to be converted from the multi-section Sage layout, and normalises it automatically.

`openingbalances.csv`

Sets the opening balance for each GL account. **Required header row.**

Column	Type	Description
`account_number`	Text	Must match an account in `glmaster`
`opening_balance`	Decimal	Opening balance amount (always positive)
`balance_type`	Text	`Dr` or `Cr` — the normal balance side of the account

Example rows:

```
account_number,opening_balance,balance_type
1060,75189.37,Dr
1200,18893.60,Dr
2110,4219.79,Cr
2310,12846.47,Cr
3560,77821.48,Cr
```

Opening balances are loaded into `glmaster.opening_balance` and are used by the Trial Balance and Balance Sheet reports as the fiscal year starting point. If an account appears in `openingbalances.csv` but not in `gldetails.csv`, it is created in `glmaster` with a zero transaction balance.

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6. Initial Configuration

All configuration is done inside the application under **Configuration** in the left sidebar. No SQL scripts are needed.

6.1 Company Information

Configuration → Company Info

Setting	Description
Company Name	Appears on every invoice PDF and report header
Address lines, City, Province, Postal	Appears on invoice PDF
Phone / Fax	Contact information on invoices
Email	Default reply-to address for outbound email
Website	Shown on invoice footer
Logo	Upload a PNG/JPG; appears top-left on PDF invoices

6.2 Chart of Accounts

Configuration → Chart of Accounts
(also accessible as GL Chart of Accounts in the sidebar)

Account number ranges used by the reporting engine:

Range	Category
1000–1999	Current Assets
2000–2999	Liabilities
3000–3999	Equity
4000–4999	Revenue
5000–9999	Expenses

Accounts can be added, edited, or deleted here. The `balance_type` field controls whether an account is normally debited (`Dr`) or credited (`Cr`), which governs how the GL summary is calculated.

6.3 Tax Codes

Configuration → Tax Codes

Each tax code can have one or more component rates (e.g., GST 5% + PST 7%). Assign tax codes to customers to control which taxes appear on their invoices.

Example — Ontario HST (single-component, harmonised):

Code	Component	Rate	GL Account
HST-ON	HST	13%	2200 (HST Payable)

Example — Quebec TPS / TVQ (two-component):

Quebec uses two separate taxes that must each be tracked independently:

Code	Component	Rate	GL Account	Notes
TPS-TVQ-QC	TPS (GST)	5%	2210 (TPS Payable)	Federal goods and services tax
TPS-TVQ-QC	TVQ (QST)	9.975%	2220 (TVQ Payable)	Quebec provincial sales tax — applied on the pre-tax amount, not on TPS

> **TVQ rate note:** The TVQ rate is **9.975%** (not 10%). It is applied to the subtotal before TPS, so the combined effective rate on a $100 invoice is $5.00 TPS + $9.98 TVQ = **$14.98 total tax** (14.98%).

To set this up in MyAccounting:

1. Go to **Configuration → Tax Codes → New Tax Code**.
2. Enter code `TPS-TVQ-QC` and description `Quebec TPS/TVQ`.
3. Add the first component: name `TPS`, rate `5`, GL account `2210`.
4. Add the second component: name `TVQ`, rate `9.975`, GL account `2220`.
5. Save.
6. Assign `TPS-TVQ-QC` to each Quebec-based customer under **Configuration → Customers**.

Both tax lines will appear separately on the invoice PDF and will post to their respective payable accounts when the invoice is posted to GL.

6.4 GL Account Mappings

Configuration → Settings → Accounting

These mappings control where the system posts transactions:

Setting Key	Purpose	Typical Account
`ar_account`	Accounts Receivable (Dr on invoice post)	1100
`revenue_account`	Default revenue (Cr on invoice post)	4000
`tax_account`	Default tax payable (Cr on invoice post)	2200
`cash_account`	Bank / cash account (Dr on receipt post)	1010
`invoice_prefix`	Invoice number prefix	`INV-`
`tax_rate`	Default tax rate %	13

> Customers can have their own `revenue_account` override — useful when different clients map to different revenue streams.

6.5 Payment Terms

Configuration → Payment Terms

Define terms such as `Net 30`, `Net 15`, `Due on Receipt`. Assign a default per customer.

6.6 Customers

Configuration → Customers

Required fields for each customer:

Field	Notes
Company Name	Displayed on invoices and the AR list
Accounting Contact	Name used in invoice salutation
Accounting Email	Default To: address when emailing an invoice
Address	Printed on invoice PDF
Tax Code	Controls which taxes are applied to their invoices
Revenue Account	Optional override of the default revenue GL account
Language	`en` or `fr` — controls the language of the generated PDF

6.7 Inventory / Services

Configuration → Inventory

Each service item has:

Field	Notes
Item Code	Short identifier used on invoice lines
Description	Default description; editable per invoice line
Unit Price	Default price; editable per invoice line
Revenue Account	GL account credited when this item is billed

6.8 Projects

Configuration → Projects

Assign a project code to invoices and timesheets for project-level revenue tracking.

6.9 Salesmen / Consultants

Configuration → Salesmen

The Salesmen table is a flexible people register. Depending on your industry, the same record type can represent:

Industry	Typical use of a Salesman record
IT Consulting	Independent consultant or sub-contractor billing hours to a client
Real Estate	Agent managing listings and client relationships
Construction / Services	Project manager responsible for a contract or job
General	Any internal staff member who is assigned to invoices or timesheets

Each record holds:

Field	Description
Name	Full name as it appears on invoices, timesheets, and reports
Email	Work email address
Phone	Contact number
Role / Title	e.g., Consultant, Project Manager, Real Estate Agent
Google Email	Gmail address used for Google services integration (optional)
OAuth Client ID	From the Google Cloud project — enables Calendar / Drive / Gmail access (optional)
OAuth Client Secret	Paired with the Client ID above (optional)
Client Portal URL	URL of the external portal (e.g., a government procurement site) used to pull timesheet data (optional)
Portal Username	Login credential for the client portal (optional)
Portal Password	Stored encrypted in the `passwords` table (optional)

Typical setup by industry:

- **IT Consultant / Sub-contractor** — Create one record per consultant. Assign them to invoices and monthly timesheets. Connect Google credentials if they use Google Calendar for scheduling or Google Drive for document sharing.
- **Real Estate Agent** — Create one record per agent. Assign the agent to client invoices (commissions, fees). The portal credentials can store MLS or brokerage portal access if timesheet imports are used.
- **Project Manager** — Create one record per PM. Link the PM to projects and invoices for that engagement. Use the portal fields to track access to client project management systems.

> A salesman record is not the same as a user account. A person can have both — a salesman record (for assignment to invoices/timesheets) and a user account (to log in to MyAccounting). They are linked by matching email addresses but managed separately.

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7. User Accounts and Security

7.1 Creating Users

Configuration → Users → New User

1. Enter username and initial password.
2. Assign role: **Admin** or **User**.
3. For **User** role, set per-module access levels (see below).
4. Click **Save**.

7.2 Access Levels

Each module can be set independently for non-admin users:

Level	What the user can do
Full	Create, edit, delete, and post in this module
View Only	Can see records but all write buttons are disabled
(not listed)	Module is hidden from the sidebar entirely

Modules with access control: GL Chart of Accounts, Journal Entry, Reports, Configuration, Invoicing, Cash Receipts, Timesheets, Database Backup, Accountant Copy, Utilities.

7.3 Password Policy

- Passwords are hashed with **PBKDF2-HMAC SHA-256** and 260,000 iterations — no plain-text passwords are stored.
- Admins can reset any user's password via **Configuration → Users → Reset Password**.
- Enforce strong passwords at the policy level (minimum 8 characters recommended).

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8. Email Configuration

Configuration → Settings → Email

MyAccounting sends invoices directly from the application using SMTP.

Setting	Description
SMTP Host	e.g., `smtp.gmail.com`
SMTP Port	`587` (TLS) or `465` (SSL)
Username	The sending email address
Password	SMTP password or App Password (for Gmail)
Use TLS	Enable for port 587
From Name	Display name in the From: field

Gmail setup

1. Enable 2-Step Verification on the Google account.
2. Generate an **App Password** at myaccount.google.com/apppasswords.
3. Use the 16-character App Password as the SMTP password in MyAccounting.
4. SMTP Host: `smtp.gmail.com`, Port: `587`, TLS: enabled.

Videotron or Bell email setup

Customers using a **Videotron** (`@videotron.ca`) or **Bell** (`@bell.net`, `@sympatico.ca`) email address must contact their internet provider directly to obtain the correct SMTP credentials before configuring MyAccounting.

What to ask your provider:

- The **master email address** (the primary account email, not a sub-account) — this is the address that has SMTP send permissions
- The **email password** for that master account
- The **outgoing SMTP server** address and port

Known SMTP settings (verify with your provider — these may change):

Provider	SMTP Host	Port	Security
Videotron	`relais.videotron.ca`	`587`	TLS
Bell / Sympatico	`smtp.bell.net`	`465`	SSL

> **Important:** Videotron and Bell sometimes restrict SMTP access to the **master account** only. Sub-accounts or alias addresses may not be permitted to send via SMTP even with the correct password. If authentication fails, call your provider's technical support line and ask specifically to enable **SMTP relay** for your email address.

Testing

After saving SMTP settings, use **Email Invoice** on any draft invoice to send a test. Check the `invoice_email_log` table if delivery confirmation is needed.

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9. Google Services Integration (Optional)

MyAccounting can connect to Gmail, Google Calendar, and Google Drive via OAuth 2.0. This is configured per salesman/consultant and allows those services to be accessed directly from the **Utilities** section of the application.

Prerequisites

1. A Google account (Gmail address)

Each consultant who will use this integration needs a Gmail address (e.g., `name@gmail.com`). This is the account that will be authorised to access Calendar, Drive, and Gmail within MyAccounting.

2. A Google Cloud project

Google requires that any application accessing its APIs be registered in the **Google Cloud Console**. This is a free, one-time setup.

1. Go to **https://console.cloud.google.com** and sign in with the consultant's Google account.
2. At the top of the page, click **Select a project** → **New Project**.
3. Name the project (e.g., `MyAccounting`) and click **Create**.
4. Wait a few seconds, then confirm the new project is selected in the dropdown at the top.

3. Enable the required APIs

Once the project is created, three API "switches" must be turned on:

1. In the left menu go to **APIs & Services** → **Library**.
2. Search for and **Enable** each of the following:
   - **Gmail API**
   - **Google Calendar API**
   - **Google Drive API**

4. Configure the OAuth Consent Screen

This screen tells Google what application is requesting access.

1. Go to **APIs & Services** → **OAuth consent screen**.
2. Select **External** and click **Create**.
3. Fill in the required fields:
   - **App name**: `MyAccounting`
   - **User support email**: the consultant's Gmail address
   - **Developer contact email**: the consultant's Gmail address
4. Click **Save and Continue** through the remaining screens (all optional fields can be skipped).
5. On the final summary screen click **Back to Dashboard**.
6. Click **Publish App** and confirm — this allows the consultant's own account to use the integration without waiting for Google's review process.

> **"External" vs "Internal":** Choose **External** unless the Google account belongs to a Google Workspace (G Suite) organisation. For personal Gmail accounts, External is the only option.

5. Create OAuth 2.0 Credentials

This step generates the **Client ID** and **Client Secret** that MyAccounting needs.

1. Go to **APIs & Services** → **Credentials**.
2. Click **+ Create Credentials** → **OAuth client ID**.
3. Under **Application type**, select **Desktop app**.
4. Give it any name (e.g., `MyAccounting Desktop`) and click **Create**.
5. A dialog appears with:
   - **Client ID** — a long string ending in `.apps.googleusercontent.com`
   - **Client Secret** — a shorter alphanumeric string
6. Copy both values — you will paste them into MyAccounting in the next step.

> The credentials can always be retrieved later from **APIs & Services** → **Credentials** in the Google Cloud Console.

Setup steps in MyAccounting

1. Go to **Configuration** → **Salesmen** → select the consultant → **Edit Salesman**.
2. In the **Google Account Settings** section, enter:
   - **Google Email** — the consultant's Gmail address
   - **OAuth Client ID** — pasted from step 5 above
   - **OAuth Client Secret** — pasted from step 5 above
3. Click **Save**.
4. Click **Authorize** — a browser window opens for Google sign-in and consent.
5. Sign in with the same Gmail address and click **Allow** on the permissions screen.
6. After consent, tokens are saved automatically and the integration is active.

The consultant can then access Gmail, Google Calendar, and Google Drive from **Utilities** in the left sidebar.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Resolution
"Access blocked" error from Google	Return to the OAuth consent screen in Google Cloud Console and click **Publish App**
Wrong Google account opens	Verify the **Google Email** field in the Salesman record matches the account used during Authorize
Tiles in Utilities do not open	Ensure the default web browser is set (Chrome or Edge recommended)
"Invalid client" error	The Client ID or Client Secret was copied incorrectly — retrieve them again from **Credentials** in the Cloud Console

> For a plain-language walkthrough aimed at non-technical users, see documentation/SetupGoogleServicesWithMyAccounting.md.

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10. Migrating from Another System

10.1 Migrating from Sage 50

MyAccounting's import script accepts a Sage 50 G/L detail export.

1. In Sage 50: **Reports** → **Financials** → **General Ledger** → **Export to CSV**.
2. Save as `importdir\gldetails.csv`.
3. Run `python import_data.py`.

The importer maps Sage columns to the `glmaster` and `gldetails` tables, preserving account numbers, names, transaction history, and opening balances.

Column mapping (Sage 50 → MyAccounting):

Sage Column	MyAccounting Column
Account Number	`account_number`
Account Name	`account_name`
Date	`trans_date`
Source	`source_number`
Comment	`description`
Debits	`debits`
Credits	`credits`

Also prepare:

- `importdir\customers.txt` — one customer per line, comma-separated
- `importdir\inventory.txt` — one item per line
- `importdir\openingbalances.csv` — account number and opening balance

10.2 Opening Balances

If not using the import script, enter opening balances manually:

1. **GL Chart of Accounts** → select each account → set **Opening Balance**.
2. Alternatively, post a general journal entry dated the first day of the fiscal year with debits and credits matching your trial balance from the old system.
3. Verify with **Reports** → **Trial Balance** that the total debits equal total credits.

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11. Go-Live Checklist

Complete every item before handing the system to end users.

Database

- [ ] `myaccounting` database created and accessible with Windows Auth
- [ ] All tables created (launch app once — `ensure_app_tables()` runs automatically)
- [ ] Opening balances imported and verified against Trial Balance

Configuration

- [ ] Company name, address, logo entered
- [ ] Chart of Accounts reviewed and adjusted
- [ ] Tax codes configured (rate and GL account)
- [ ] GL account mappings set: AR, Revenue, Tax, Cash
- [ ] Payment terms created
- [ ] At least one customer entered
- [ ] At least one service item entered
- [ ] Invoice number prefix and starting sequence confirmed

Users

- [ ] Admin account created with a strong password
- [ ] All end-user accounts created with appropriate access levels
- [ ] Default admin credentials changed from any test values

Email

- [ ] SMTP settings saved and tested (send a test invoice PDF via email)

Backup

- [ ] SQL Server backup job scheduled (see §15)
- [ ] First manual backup taken before go-live

Sign-off

- [ ] Trial Balance verified against previous system
- [ ] At least one test invoice created, posted to GL, and receipt recorded
- [ ] Reports reviewed: Trial Balance, Income Statement, Balance Sheet

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12. Day-One Workflow

Typical daily workflow for a service business after go-live:

```
Morning
  └─ Check Dashboard: review AR balances and any unposted journals

New Work
  └─ Configuration → Customers (add new client if needed)
  └─ Invoicing → New Invoice → complete lines → Save (status: Draft)

Bill the Client
  └─ Invoicing → select invoice → Generate PDF (review)
  └─ Invoicing → Email Invoice (status auto-sets to Sent)

Payment Received
  └─ Cash Receipts → New Receipt → link to invoice → Save → Post to GL
  └─ Invoice status → set to Paid

Month End
  └─ Journal Entry → review drafts → Post all
  └─ Reports → Trial Balance (verify balance)
  └─ Reports → Income Statement / Balance Sheet (review with accountant)
  └─ Database Backup → Run Backup
```

---

13. Invoice Lifecycle

An invoice moves through the following states:

```
[New Invoice saved]
        │
        ▼
    ┌───────┐
    │ Draft │  ── is_draft = 1
    └───────┘
        │  Email Invoice / manually set Sent
        ▼
    ┌──────┐
    │ Sent │  ── email_sent = 1
    └──────┘
        │
        ├──────────────────────┐
        ▼                      ▼
   ┌──────┐                ┌───────────┐
   │ Paid │  is_paid = 1   │ Cancelled │  is_cancelled = 1
   └──────┘  paid_date     └───────────┘  cancelled_date
       │
       │  Post to GL
       ▼
   ┌────────┐
   │ Posted │  is_posted = 1, posted_date
   └────────┘
       │
       └── GL entries created (DR: AR, CR: Revenue, CR: Tax Payable)
```

Status flags stored per invoice:

Column	Type	Set when
`is_draft`	BIT	Status = Draft
`is_paid`	BIT	Status = Paid
`is_cancelled`	BIT	Status = Cancelled
`is_posted`	BIT	Status = Posted (also set by Post to GL)
`paid_date`	DATETIME	First time Paid status is saved
`cancelled_date`	DATETIME	First time Cancelled status is saved
`posted_date`	DATETIME	First time Posted / Post to GL runs
`email_sent`	BIT	Email successfully sent

The **Invoicing** list filter uses these boolean flags directly, not the `status` text field, so a filter by "Posted" will always return invoices where `is_posted = 1`.

---

14. Period-End Procedures

Month End

1. **Review unposted journals** — Dashboard shows the count. Open **Journal Entry**, review all Draft entries, post or delete.
2. **Verify AR** — **Reports** → **AR Aging** (or review the AR balance on the Dashboard). Confirm all paid invoices are marked Paid.
3. **Post outstanding receipts** — **Cash Receipts** → filter Unposted → Post to GL.
4. **Run Trial Balance** — **Reports** → **Trial Balance** → verify debits = credits.
5. **Export for accountant** — **Accountant Copy** → generate export → send `exportdir\accountant.csv`.
6. **Back up the database** — **Database Backup** or via SQL Server.

Year End

1. Complete all month-end steps above.
2. Post any adjusting journal entries provided by the accountant.
3. Verify the final Trial Balance.
4. Generate the year-end **Income Statement** and **Balance Sheet** (PDF and Excel).
5. Take a labelled year-end database backup (e.g., `myaccounting_YE_2026.bak`).
6. Update opening balances for the new fiscal year if required.

---

15. Backup and Recovery

MyAccounting stores all data in SQL Server. Two backup options are available — the recommended daily option for end users is the built-in **Database Backup** screen inside the application. The SQL Server methods below are available to IT administrators who prefer automated or scripted backups.

In-app backup (recommended for daily use)

The **Database Backup** screen is the easiest way for a user to back up their data without any technical knowledge. It is accessible only to administrators.

Steps:

1. Click **Database Backup** in the left sidebar.
2. The screen shows the server name and database name at the top so you can confirm you are backing up the correct database.
3. Click **Browse...** and select the folder where you want the backup file saved.
   - Choose a location you can find easily later — for example `C:\Backups\` or a folder on a USB drive or network share.
   - Make sure the folder already exists before selecting it.
4. Click **Backup Database**.
5. A confirmation dialog shows the full path of the file that will be created (e.g., `C:\Backups\myaccounting_20260502_143012.bak`). Click **Yes** to proceed.
6. When complete, a message confirms the backup was successful and shows the file path.

The backup file is named automatically with the database name and a date-time stamp (e.g., `myaccounting_20260502_143012.bak`), so running the backup multiple times in a day creates separate files and never overwrites a previous backup.

Recommended routine:

- Run a backup at the **end of each working day** before closing the application.
- Once a week, copy the `.bak` file to an external drive, USB key, or cloud storage folder (OneDrive, Google Drive) so you have an off-site copy.
- Keep at least the last **7 daily backups** before deleting older files.

> **Tip:** Keep a shortcut to your backup folder on your desktop so you can quickly drag the `.bak` file to your USB drive or cloud folder after each backup.

Manual backup (SQL Server Management Studio)

For IT administrators who prefer to run backups manually from SQL Server Management Studio:

```
BACKUP DATABASE myaccounting
TO DISK = 'C:\Backups\myaccounting_20260502.bak'
WITH FORMAT, COMPRESSION;
```

Automated backup (SQL Server Agent job)

Schedule a daily job using SQL Server Agent:

```
EXEC msdb.dbo.sp_add_job @job_name = N'MyAccounting Daily Backup';
-- Add a job step that runs the BACKUP DATABASE statement above
-- Schedule: daily at 23:00
```

Recovery

If data needs to be restored from a backup, the following SQL command can be run by an IT administrator in SQL Server Management Studio:

```
RESTORE DATABASE myaccounting
FROM DISK = 'C:\Backups\myaccounting_20260502.bak'
WITH REPLACE;
```

> **Not comfortable with this?** Restoring a database is a technical procedure. If you are not familiar with SQL Server, **contact your IT support provider** and give them the `.bak` file you want to restore. They can perform the restore safely and verify the data is intact before you resume using the application. Always confirm with IT before overwriting the live database.

> Always test recovery to a separate named database before relying on a backup file in a production scenario.

---

16. Building and Deploying a New Release

Stage 1 — Build the application

```
cd C:\local\python\MyAccounting
build.bat
```

Output: `dist\MyAccounting\MyAccounting.exe`

Stage 2 — Build the installer

```
cd DeploymentPackage
build_installer.bat
```

Output: `DeploymentPackage\dist\MyAccountingSetup.exe`

Distributing an update to an existing install

1. Back up the client's database before deploying.
2. Close MyAccounting on all workstations.
3. Run `MyAccountingSetup.exe` on the target machine — the installer will overwrite application files while leaving the database intact.
4. On first launch after the update, `db.ensure_app_tables()` automatically applies any new column migrations.

> **Never** manually alter the `myaccounting` database schema — let the application's migration logic manage it.

---

17. Installing a New Version

When a new version of MyAccounting is released, paid users can download the latest installer from the **SegiunDev Google Drive** folder:

> https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1w7wHusHSqHUsQxbaIEQ6PecdkCj5bgHc?usp=drive_link

Access to this folder is granted to all users with a paid licence. If you do not have access, contact SegiunDev support to have your Google account added.

Steps to upgrade

1. **Download the latest installer** — open the Google Drive link above, find the most recent `MyAccountingSetup_vX.X.X.exe` file, and download it to your computer.
2. **Close MyAccounting** — make sure the application is not running on any workstation before proceeding.
3. **Back up your database** — run a database backup from inside the application (see Section 15) or ask your IT administrator to take a SQL Server backup. This protects your data in the unlikely event that something goes wrong during the upgrade.
4. **Run the installer** — double-click `MyAccountingSetup_vX.X.X.exe` and follow the on-screen prompts. The installer will overwrite the existing application files while leaving your database completely intact.
5. **Launch MyAccounting** — on first startup after the upgrade, the application automatically detects any new database columns or tables required by the new version and applies the changes for you. No manual steps are needed.
6. **Verify** — log in, open a few invoices or reports, and confirm everything looks correct.

> **Tip:** If you have MyAccounting installed on more than one workstation, repeat steps 3–6 on each machine. The database upgrade happens automatically on the first machine that connects; subsequent machines only need the application files updated.

> If the installer asks to overwrite configuration files (e.g., `app.json`), choose **No** to keep your existing company settings unless the release notes specifically instruct otherwise.

18. Troubleshooting

Cannot connect to SQL Server

Symptom	Resolution
"Login failed" or "Cannot connect" on startup	Ensure SQL Server service is running: `services.msc` → SQL Server (MSSQLSERVER) → Start
"Data source name not found"	ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server is not installed. Download from Microsoft and install.
"Access denied"	The Windows user account does not have access to the `myaccounting` database. Grant `db_owner` in SSMS.

Application won't launch

Symptom	Resolution
`ModuleNotFoundError: pyodbc`	Run `pip install pyodbc`
`ModuleNotFoundError: reportlab`	Run `pip install reportlab`
Missing `tcl86t.dll` / `tk86t.dll`	Anaconda path in `MyAccounting.spec` is incorrect — update `_anaconda` to the correct path
Blank screen after login	Database migration failed — check the console for an error from `ensure_app_tables()`

Invoice filter shows no results

- The boolean flags (`is_draft`, `is_paid`, etc.) may not be set for older records. This is corrected automatically on each application start by the `UPDATE invoicemaster SET is_draft = CASE WHEN status = 'Draft'...` migration in `db.py`. Restart the application and retry.

PDF generation fails

- Verify ReportLab is installed: `pip install reportlab`
- Confirm the company logo path in settings points to a valid PNG or JPG file.
- If the export directory is missing, create `exportdir\` in the application folder.

Email fails to send

Symptom	Resolution
“Authentication failed”	Use an App Password (not the regular Gmail password) when 2FA is enabled
“Connection refused”	Check SMTP host and port; ensure TLS/SSL setting matches the port
“Timeout”	Firewall is blocking outbound SMTP — allow port 587 (TLS) or 465 (SSL)

French translation not showing

- Translation files (`.mo`) must be compiled before running:

```
python compile_mo.py
```

- Verify `locale\fr\LC_MESSAGES\myaccounting.mo` exists.
- The language toggle (EN / FR) at the bottom of the sidebar restarts the interface in the selected language.

End of Implementation Guide